AI USE DISCLOSURE

The hidden cost of a prompt

BOUVIER & KING / EDHEC - AI FOR BUSINESS / 4 NOVEMBER 2026

Human direction

The project authors selected AI resource consumption as the ethical challenge and requested an interactive public website with estimated water, electricity and CO2 counters, example prompts, and a source list.

How AI was used

OpenAI Codex assisted with brainstorming and narrowing the concept; finding and cross-checking primary research; drafting and refining the English educational content and methodological explanations; writing the website and interactive scenario logic; and supporting implementation checks and GitHub Pages publication. AI also helped prepare this disclosure. The source links and assumptions are made available on the website.

What the counters represent

The website is an educational simulation. It applies published reference values and clearly stated assumptions to demonstration scenarios. It does not call a live AI model, measure a visitor's actual prompt, or measure the website's own resource consumption. Prompt examples illustrate uses; they are not individually metered measurements. Scaling an example is a scenario calculation, not a forecast of real-world totals.

Limits and responsibility

AI assistance cannot independently establish the true environmental footprint of a particular commercial AI request. Results depend on the model, workload, infrastructure, location and accounting boundaries. Water consumption is distinct from water withdrawal, and emissions estimates depend on the electricity and carbon-accounting assumptions. Findings from different studies may not be directly comparable. Final interpretation, source evaluation and submission decisions remain the authors' responsibility.